THOMAS SMITH

FIELD MARKETING | EVENT OPERATIONS | PROGRAM COORDINATION

CAREER IMPACT

87
SHOWS & PROGRAMS PRODUCED / CO-PRODUCED

10
YEARS OF EVENT PRODUCTION

4
MULTI-DAY PLANO COMEDY FESTIVALS

337
LISTED FESTIVAL PERFORMER APPEARANCES

CORE SKILLS

Event Logistics & Execution
Program Operations
Multi-Venue Coordination
Performer & Partner Communications
Registration Workflows
Promotional Materials
Volunteer Coordination
Website & Digital QA
Remote Event Production
Live Troubleshooting

TOOLS

Eventbrite • Zoom • Discord • OBS • Powtoon • Microsoft Office • Google Analytics • Jira • Azure DevOps • TestRail • Postman

EDUCATION

SUNY Adirondack
Queensbury, NY

Ballston Spa High School
Ballston Spa, NY

SELECTED TRAINING

Google Agile Project Management
Google Digital Marketing & E-Commerce
Introduction to Events Management
Atlassian Jira
IBM Java Programming
Software QA • JUnit • Selenium

PORTFOLIO

smithqa2007.github.io

SUMMARY

Back in 2015 a decision was made for me to leave the traditional workforce and dedicate my time to my family. I had young kid's and it just didn't feel right that somebody else was raising them. I didn't reinvent the wheel. Moms had the stay-at-home parenting thing locked down since the dawn of time. But it wasn't traditional and I felt like I was a bit of a pioneer. I was humbled. Boy, was I humbled. Over and over again. I learned more about compassion, team work and leadership then all of the years I spent working in corporate America. The one passion I had during my journey was producing shows. Eighty-seven shows produced in ten years. It took years of failure, dedication, and hard work to become a fantastic stay at home parent and equally the same to become a renowned show producer.

EXPERIENCE

Event Producer / Event Operations

Independent Productions & Plano Comedy Festival | 2013–2022

- Produced or co-produced 87 comedy shows and festival programs across independent venues, wineries, theaters, Arlington Improv, multi-location festivals, and virtual platforms
- Helped produce four Plano Comedy Festivals totaling 68 shows and 337 performer appearances, growing from 5 shows / 20 performers in 2018 to 30 shows / 140 performers in 2022.
- Managed event operations including show programming, performer communications, scheduling, venues, volunteers, registration workflows, sponsor assets, promotional materials, attendee operations, and live execution.
- Produced recurring event series at Al's Roadhouse, The Saratoga Winery, Art Centre Theatre, and Checkered Past Winery, plus productions at TJ's Flightline and Arlington Improv.
- Created and verified show posters, performer assets, social media content, schedules, registration links, and other digital materials, applying QA practices to identify errors before launch.
- Helped transition the 2020 festival to a four-day international virtual event using Eventbrite, Zoom, Discord, OBS, and Powtoon, coordinating performers, audiences, volunteers, and digital production across a distributed environment. Read the story on my Github.
- Supported on-site setup/breakdown, performer and volunteer coordination, multi-venue logistics, and real-time troubleshooting, keeping programs moving on schedule.

QA Analyst

AWS Truepower — Albany, NY | 2011–2015

- Planned and executed functional, regression, system, and UAT testing while maintaining accurate test cases, defect records, project status information, and release documentation.
- Collaborated with developers and stakeholders to clarify requirements, identify gaps early, track resolution, and meet project deadlines.
- Supported a major Windnavigator website redesign delivered on schedule with minimal defects and was selected to test a standalone Windnavigator application for GE.

Additional Tech & Customer Support Experience

Time Warner Cable — Albany, NY | 2010–2011

- Provided customer support while troubleshooting service-related questions and resolving customer issues.
- Explained technical information and solutions clearly to customers with varying levels of technical knowledge.
- Documented customer interactions accurately while maintaining a high standard of service.

Riversource Life Insurance — Albany, NY | 2007–2010

- Trained new employees on customer service procedures, systems, and organizational processes.
- Helped employees develop effective communication, problem-solving, and customer service skills.
- Provided customer support and resolved account and service-related issues.

SGS Testcom — Malta, NY | 2004–2007

- Provided technical helpdesk support and troubleshooting for customers using software and computer systems.
- Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software, connectivity, and application-related issues.
- Assisted users through troubleshooting processes and communicated technical information in an understandable, customer-focused manner.
- Escalated complex technical issues to appropriate internal teams and followed up to support resolution.
- Worked with engineering and software development teams on quality assurance and technical issues.
- Served as a team leader, supporting employees with technical questions, customer issues, and day-to-day operations.
- Participated in new-hire training and helped employees develop technical and customer service skills.